

Cat Insurance Worth It — Action Checklist

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CALCULATE YOUR BREAK-EVEN POINT

- ☐ **Estimate your cat's expected lifespan using 15 years as a baseline for indoor cats or 12 years for rescue cats with unknown history.:** Estimate your cat's expected lifespan using 15 years as a baseline for indoor cats or 12 years for rescue cats with unknown history.
- ☐ **Calculate your total insurance premium cost by multiplying your monthly premium by 12 and then by your cat's estimated remaining years.:** Calculate your total insurance premium cost by multiplying your monthly premium by 12 and then by your cat's estimated remaining years.
- ☐ **Research typical vet costs including routine visits (\$150-300), common emergencies (\$1,500-3,500), and major emergencies (\$3,000-8,000) to build an accurate cost picture.:** Research typical vet costs including routine visits (\$150-300), common emergencies (\$1,500-3,500), and major emergencies (\$3,000-8,000) to build an accurate cost picture.
- ☐ **Compare your total expected vet costs against total premium costs to determine whether insurance is likely to save or cost you money over your cat's lifetime.:** Compare your total expected vet costs against total premium costs to determine whether insurance is likely to save or cost you money over your cat's lifetime.

AVOID HIDDEN PROVIDER PITFALLS

- ☐ **Request the breed-specific exclusion list in writing before signing up because some providers exclude hereditary conditions common to your cat's breed.:** Request the breed-specific exclusion list in writing before signing up because some providers exclude hereditary conditions common to your cat's breed.
- ☐ **Check annual coverage caps carefully since a \$20,000 cap may not cover your cat's needs if treatment exceeds that amount in one year.:** Check annual coverage caps carefully since a \$20,000 cap may not cover your cat's needs if treatment exceeds that amount in one year.
- ☐ **Read the pre-existing condition clause thoroughly and do not rely on verbal explanations from sales representatives about what is and is not covered.:** Read the pre-existing condition clause thoroughly and do not rely on verbal explanations from sales representatives about what is and is not covered.

- **Ask your provider for their rate increase history because most companies raise premiums 15-25% when cats reach age 8 and your actual costs will be much higher than the initial quote.:** Ask your provider for their rate increase history because most companies raise premiums 15-25% when cats reach age 8 and your actual costs will be much higher than the initial quote.

VERIFY BEFORE YOU COMMIT

- **Look up your provider's claim denial rate through your state insurance department's complaint database to see how often claims are rejected relative to competitors.:** Look up your provider's claim denial rate through your state insurance department's complaint database to see how often claims are rejected relative to competitors.
- **Consider self-insuring by depositing your monthly premium equivalent into a high-yield savings account earning 4% APY, which may outperform insurance over time.:** Consider self-insuring by depositing your monthly premium equivalent into a high-yield savings account earning 4% APY, which may outperform insurance over time.
- **Factor in your cat's breed-specific health risks since Persian, Maine Coon, and Siamese cats have known hereditary conditions that affect coverage value.:** Factor in your cat's breed-specific health risks since Persian, Maine Coon, and Siamese cats have known hereditary conditions that affect coverage value.
- **Verify reimbursement speed by asking current customers about actual payment timelines since provider promises of 5-7 days often differ from real-world experience.:** Verify reimbursement speed by asking current customers about actual payment timelines since provider promises of 5-7 days often differ from real-world experience.

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